

	RESEARCH, INNOVATION AND COMMUNITY EXTENSION OFFICE	
	JOURNAL VETTING MATRIX	VMUF-RICE-FM-003A Effectivity Date: July 7, 2025 Revision: 0

A **Journal Vetting Matrix** is a tool used by researchers, students, or academic institutions to evaluate the quality and credibility of academic journals before submitting work or citing sources.

Direction:

1. Rate each criterion from 1 to 5 based on your research.
2. Total the scores.
3. Interpret the score:

Total Score Range	Recommendation
40–50	Excellent – Recommended
30–39	Moderate – Proceed with caution
20–29	Questionable – Investigate further
<20	Poor – Avoid

Criteria	Description	Rating Scale (1–5)	Notes
Indexing	Is the journal indexed in reputable databases (e.g., Scopus, Web of Science, PubMed)?	1 = Not indexed 5 = Indexed in major databases	
Publisher Reputation	Is the publisher recognized, ethical, and well-regarded? (e.g., Elsevier, Springer, etc.)	1 = Unknown/predatory 5 = Top academic publisher	
Peer Review Process	Is there a transparent, rigorous peer-review process?	1 = No/unclear 5 = Double-blind, detailed reviews	
Open Access Policy	Are the OA policies clear, ethical, and properly licensed (e.g., Creative Commons)?	1 = No policy or predatory OA 5 = Ethical and transparent OA	
Impact Factor / Ranking	Journal's impact factor or ranking within its field	1 = No impact factor 5 = High-impact/ranked top-tier	
Editorial Board	Are the editors respected researchers with institutional affiliations?	1 = Unknown or no listed board 5 = Reputable scholars	
Acceptance Rate	Lower rates may indicate higher quality (context-dependent)	1 = >80% 5 = <20% (high selectivity)	

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Frequency & Longevity	How often is the journal published, and for how long has it existed?	1 = New/infrequent 5 = Long-running, regular issues	
Ethics & Transparency	COPE membership, plagiarism checks, retraction policy, etc.	1 = No info 5 = Full compliance with COPE/ICMJE	
Predatory Indicators	Does the journal exhibit red flags (e.g., on Beall's List, aggressive spam emails)?	1 = Many red flags 5 = No red flags	

TOTAL SCORE: _____

NAME OF RESEARCHER/S: _____

RESEARCH COORDINATOR: _____

SIGNATURE: _____

DATE: _____

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